OPEN LETTER · EYE ON SHOALHAVEN COUNCIL

Mayor White asked to name the outside party influences behind bullying claims

Sent 25 September 2026 · To Mayor White, Shoalhaven City Council · Response requested by 16 October 2026

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25 September 2026

Mayor Patricia White
Shoalhaven City Council
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Open letter — your statement of 21 September 2026 and "outside party influences"

Dear Mayor,

On 21 September 2026 you and Cr Karlee Dunn resigned from the Shoalhaven Independents Group. Your statement, as reported by 2ST and Power FM, attributed bullying and intimidation to "several Councillors and outside party influences connected to the Group".

This letter is about people outside the Council only.

The Model Code of Conduct (clauses 9.10 and 9.11) restricts councillors from making allegations about suspected breaches of the Code other than through a complaint under the Procedures. I am not asking you to make any allegation about any councillor or member of staff, or to disclose anything about a Code of Conduct complaint. People outside the Council are not bound by the Code, and the questions below concern them alone.

In 2024 you told voters that SIG had never run candidates at state or federal elections and that you had never been asked to vote a particular way. You contrasted that with the major parties, which you said take direction from local branches or head office. Your statement this week suggests that has changed. Residents and ratepayers are entitled to know whether decisions of their Council have been shaped by people they did not elect.

My questions are:

1. Which political party or parties did you mean by "outside party influences"?

1. Will you name the person or persons outside the Council who sought to influence you? If you will not, why not?

1. **If you will not name them, what did they want? In particular, did any of it concern a matter that was before Council, or expected to come before Council? If so, which matter?**

1. **Has the conduct of those people been reported to any authority, such as the Independent Commission Against Corruption, the NSW Electoral Commission, NSW Police or the Office of Local Government? I am not asking for the content of any report, only whether one has been made and to which body.**

I will publish whatever response is received, including none.

Yours sincerely,

Steve Prothero
Publisher, Eye on Shoalhaven Council

Note to councillors receiving a copy of this letter: The questions above are put to the Mayor on the public record.

If you believe they warrant answers, you are in a position to raise them directly in the chamber, through a Question on Notice or a question to the Mayor in open council.

That is one of the most effective ways to place these matters on the public record in a forum where a response cannot be declined.

This publication will report whatever is raised and whatever is answered.
